RICHIE DILIP KURIAN

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

I am a Lecturer in Economics at the University of Essex, appointed in September 2026, and a PhD candidate in Economics at Essex, specialising in experimental and behavioural economics, with applications to public finance, development, and financial formalisation. My doctoral research combines laboratory experimental design with applied microeconometrics to study how individuals adapt their financial and reporting behaviour under risk, liquidity constraints, and collective-action pressure. Alongside this research I have accumulated more than four years of undergraduate and postgraduate teaching experience, spanning lecture and seminar delivery, preparation of teaching materials, assessment marking, and — at St Berchmans College — full module leadership and curriculum development across mathematical, behavioural, microeconomic, macroeconomic, and econometric subjects. I am committed to face-to-face, student-centred teaching, and I am keen to take on greater curriculum and course-leadership responsibility, building on my experience designing syllabi and learning outcomes at St Berchmans. I am particularly well placed to teach and lead activities in experimental and behavioural economics, econometrics, applied development economics, and quantitative methods.

TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

I believe economics is best taught as a way of reasoning about real behaviour, not just a set of models to memorise. My teaching draws directly on my experimental and behavioural research: I use simple in-class games and real data to make abstract concepts — risk, incentives, strategic behaviour — tangible before formalising them mathematically. I aim to build inclusive, well-structured learning environments that support students from a wide range of academic and cultural backgrounds, reflecting my own route into economics via civil engineering, banking, and public administration. I value regular, specific feedback, transparent assessment criteria, and close mentoring, particularly for students undertaking independent research projects.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Experimental and behavioural economics (laboratory design, dynamic games)
- Behavioural public finance and tax compliance
- Development economics — informality, financial inclusion, and digital formalisation
- Applied microeconometrics and policy evaluation
- Economics pedagogy and curriculum design

EDUCATION

University of Essex, *10/2023 - Current*
PhD: Economics
Modules: Advanced Economic Theory, Experimental Economics, Advanced Econometrics. Thesis on behavioural responses to liquidity shocks, tax compliance, and cooperation under collective risk.

University of Essex, Colchester, ESS, *10/2022 - 10/2023*
MRes
Econometrics, Microeconometrics, MRes Microeconomics, Advanced Microeconomics, Mathematical Methods

Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU), *06/2016 - 12/2018*
MSc: Economics
Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics, Economics of Health and Education, Public Economics, Indian Economy

Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU), *01/2013 - 12/2014*
MA: Public Administration
Public Policy, Personnel Administration, Financial Administration, Development Administration

Rajiv Gandhi Institute of Technology (RIT), *07/2006 - 06/2010*
BTech: Civil Engineering
Quantity Surveying, Structural Management and Design, Geotechnical and Transportation

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching areas: theoretical and applied economics, with particular expertise in econometrics, mathematical economics, behavioural economics, and experimental economics.

Lecturer in Economics, *09/2026 - Current*
University of Essex, Department of Economics
Teaching **EC261 Management of New Technology**, **EC501 Econometrics**, and **IA212 Global Politics and Economic Policies**. For IA212, involved in the preparation of teaching materials alongside delivery. Supporting assessment and students' learning while completing doctoral research in experimental and behavioural economics.

Assistant Lecturer, *10/2024 - 09/2025*
University of Essex, Department of Economics
Delivered classes on Mathematical Economics and Behavioural Economics modules for undergraduate students. Supported assessment through marking and valuation of student answer scripts, alongside doctoral research in experimental and behavioural economics.

Assistant Professor, *06/2020 - 08/2022*
St Berchmans College
Taught Mathematical Economics, Behavioural Economics, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Operations Research, Agricultural Economics, and Economics of Health and Education to both undergraduate and postgraduate students. Led curriculum development and syllabus design in line with updated academic guidelines, structuring learning outcomes and assessment questions around Bloom's Taxonomy across the modules taught. Supervised one undergraduate and one postgraduate dissertation. Supported students' personal development and prepared them for placements, including interview technique and CV preparation, alongside broader pastoral and academic support.

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Research Officer, *01/2026 - 06/2026*
Department of Government, University of Essex
Data analysis, report writing, and data management supporting departmental research projects.

Research Officer at EBS, *02/2024 - 07/2024*
Essex Business School, University of Essex
Data analysis, report writing, data management.

Assistant Manager, *11/2016 - 12/2019*
State Bank of India, Bengaluru
Management, loan processing, financial management and evaluation — grounding in applied financial systems relevant to development and financial-inclusion research.

Project Manager, *04/2011 - 03/2015*
Highrange Builders and Developers, Kottayam
Management, surveying, planning and billing.

WORKING PAPERS

Liquidity under Constraint: Experimental Evidence on Behavioural Adaptation to Sudden Monetary Shocks (2026)
Richie Dilip Kurian — Department of Economics, University of Essex
Tax compliance, liquidity shock, demonetisation, loss aversion, availability heuristic, laboratory experiment
Uses India's 2016 demonetisation as a motivating case to design a laboratory tax-compliance experiment with a built-in liquidity shock, comparing a no-shock control against pre-announced and surprise versions of the shock. The design separates genuine gains in compliance from a purely mechanical shift of spending into formal channels, and further shows that advance warning of the shock chiefly matters for participants with prior audit experience.

Cooperation under Escalating Risk: Evidence from a Dynamic Public Goods Experiment (2026)
Richie Dilip Kurian, Friederike Mengel, Dennie van Dolder — Department of Economics, University of Essex
Dynamic public goods game, collective risk, cooperation, exponential-growth bias, laboratory experiment
Introduces a general framework for studying cooperation when the probability of collective failure evolves endogenously with group behaviour, and implements an exponential-risk variant in the laboratory, varying initial risk, contribution efficacy, risk growth rate, and group size. Smaller groups adapt more effectively to escalating risk, while larger groups are more sensitive to the pace of risk growth and to incentive design, with individual differences in growth-bias and probability-bias explaining much of the heterogeneity in contribution timing.

The Effect of Brexit on the UK and EU: A Synthetic Control Analysis (2026)
Richie Dilip Kurian, Neslihan Sakarya
Synthetic control method, Brexit, real GDP, counterfactual analysis, conformal inference
Applies the synthetic control method to quarterly real GDP data from 1960–2024 to build counterfactual growth paths for the UK and major EU economies, isolating Brexit's effects from global shocks such as COVID-19. Brexit's impact on the UK is concentrated around implementation rather than the referendum, producing short-lived fluctuations but a modest net cumulative gain by 2024, while spillovers to large EU economies such as Germany and France are broadly muted.

Behavioural Barriers to Digital and Financial Formalisation among Informal Microentrepreneurs in India (2026)
Richie Dilip Kurian, Pavanam Thomas
Financial inclusion, informality, digital payments, behavioural barriers, microenterprise
Examines why informal microenterprises across India continue to show low digital-payment adoption and financial formalisation despite the nationwide rollout of digital public infrastructure, arguing that behavioural rather than purely structural barriers play a significant and underexamined role. Using a mixed-methods design that combines structured surveys, incentivized behavioural tasks, and randomised nudge interventions with informal micro-entrepreneurs, the study applies logistic regression and structural equation modelling to test how risk and loss aversion, present bias, complexity aversion, institutional mistrust, perceived hassle costs, and social norms shape formalisation decisions, offering evidence to inform financial-inclusion and MSME formalisation policy in India.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS / PROJECTS

Effect of Social Media Affinity on Happiness (May 2022)
Wellbeing Scale, Social Media Affinity Scale, Regression, Log Regression

Women SHGs, Microfinance and Empowerment (April 2022)
Self Help Groups, Microfinance, Women Empowerment, ANOVA

Agronomy of Pepper and the Indo-ASEAN FTA: A Study of Instability in Area, Production and Yield (March 2022)
Stability Analysis

Covid-19 and Commercial Property Marketing (February 2022)
Commercial Property Marketing

Risk Attitude in the UK: An Exploration of Individual Differences and Demographic Effects (October 2022)
Behavioural Economics, Risk Preference, ANOVA, Regression

SKILLS

Research & Technical

- Statistical software: R, SPSS (primary); working knowledge of Stata and MATLAB
- Laboratory experimental design and implementation (oTree, z-Tree)
- Applied microeconometrics: DiD, ANCOVA, panel methods, synthetic control, SEM
- Data analysis and technical report writing

Teaching & Professional

- Curriculum and module design; blended learning delivery
- Preparation of teaching materials
- Assessment design, marking, and feedback
- Student supervision and mentoring
- Time management, self-motivated, multilingual

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Route into academic economics via civil engineering, commercial banking, and public administration, giving a practitioner's grounding in financial systems, project management, and public-sector processes that directly informs my applied and development economics teaching and research. Comfortable working across disciplinary boundaries and with international, multilingual student cohorts.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.